

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Who Can It Be Now?



Learning Outcome

Exchange advice and suggestions in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever received a phone call from an unknown number?
- Who was it?
- What did you say to try to get off the phone quickly?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about jobs and work.
- I can manage a phone conversation.
- I can change topics.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa gets a phone call from an **unknown*** number.

* When a number appears as "unknown", it could be an unlisted number or one from a government agency.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Vanessa: Hello? Hello? He-e-lloOoo?

Assistant Manager: Who was that?

Vanessa: I don't know. There was nobody there. The phone says "Unknown number".

Assistant Manager: Oh, an unlisted number.

Vanessa: Hello, Bistro 88, Vanessa speaking. How can I help you?

Caller: Yeah, can you put me through to the manager?

Vanessa: Yes, this is the manager. Who's speaking?

Caller: This is the Health Department. We need to make an appointment with you to come in and do a review of your menu.

Vanessa: OK, could you hold on? I can't look up my calendar right now.

Caller: Sure.

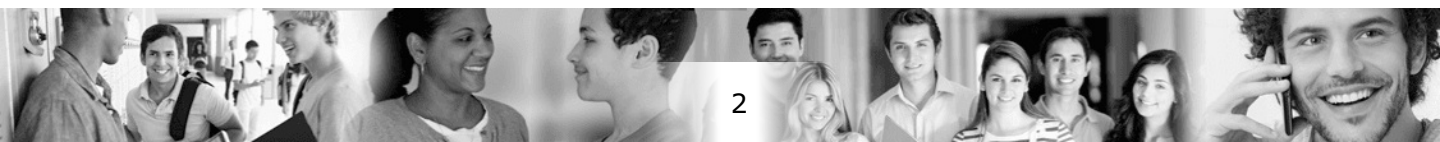
Vanessa: By the way, we forwarded our list of kitchen equipment two weeks ago, but we haven't heard back.

Caller: Yes, the records here show that you did, but I'm afraid I personally don't know about that document. Let me find out, and I'll get back to you.

Vanessa: Okay, please let me know soon. Anyway, about the appointment, how about Thursday the 12th at 9:00 a.m.?

Caller: Yeah, that's fine with us. We'll see you then.

Vanessa: Great. Thanks for calling. Bye.





Let's Practice!

Can you catch what they're talking about?

Instructions: Read the dialogue again. Write down the words to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

set a time to meet / has sent / talk / Health / Thursday the 12th in the morning

1. The caller on the phone wanted to _____ to the manager.
2. The caller on the phone was from the _____ Department.
3. The caller on the phone needed to _____ with Vanessa.
4. The appointment was set for _____.
5. Vanessa _____ a list of kitchen equipment to them.



Let's Practice!

Unscramble the words to see what they're saying.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentence. Put each word in the correct order.

1. By / equipment / two / we / list / forwarded / ago. / the / our / kitchen / of / way, / weeks

2. get / and / to / you. / I'll / Let / find / me / out, / back

3. Thursday / the / 9:00 a.m.? / about / the / appointment, / the / About / at / how / 12th



Extension Activity

Write a phone dialogue or a text chat complaining about a problem.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of a problem you might have had with your cell phone company or Internet provider.
- Write a phone dialogue or a text chat complaining about this problem. Use all the phrasal verbs that you have learned from this lesson.
- Write the responses that you would expect from the company representative.
- Write 8 - 10 lines.
- Practice the dialogue aloud with your partner.
- Change roles.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I make complaints about a problem.

☐ ☐

I manage a phone conversation using the proper action words.

☐ ☐

I reply to complaints.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- unlisted** (adjective): not listed in the telephone directory
e.g. It says unknown number on your phone because it's an unlisted number.
- to put me through** (verb): to connect a caller to someone else in the office
e.g. Hi. Can you please put me through to the manager?
- appointment** (noun): a set meeting time
e.g. We need to make an appointment with you to come in and do a review.
- to hold on** (verb): to ask the caller to wait a moment
e.g. Could you hold on? I need to look at my calendar.
- to get back to you** (expression): to send a reply later with more information
e.g. Let me find out about the document and get back to you.
- to hear back** (verb): to receive a reply by phone or e-mail
e.g. We forwarded our list of kitchen equipment two weeks ago, but we haven't heard back.
- let me know** (expression): to ask the other person to give you a reply when they find out the information
e.g. Okay, once you find out, please let me know soon.





Learning Points

Phrasal Verbs about Phone Communication

A phrasal verb is a phrase formed with a verb + preposition. Some phrasal verbs are unique to communication on the phone.

Here are more phrasal verbs that are often used for communication over the phone or videochats. Try to use some of these the next time you're chatting.

Phrasal Verb	Meaning
to speak up	to speak louder into the phone
to hang up	to end a conversation and disconnect.
to cut off	to interrupt a phone conversation
to call back	to call someone again or in return
to break up	when the other person's voice is unclear and you can't hear them well

Examples:

- *Can you please speak up a little?*
- *Just hang up and call me back when you can.*
- *You're breaking up ... I can hardly hear you.*
- *Sorry, we got cut off there ... what were you saying?*

Changing Topics on the Phone

You can use expressions to redirect a phone conversation when you wish to get off the current topic or to focus on a different topic.

To state a reason to get off the topic, you can use:

I can't look up my calendar right now. Let me get back to you on that.

To direct the other person's attention to another topic, you can use:

By the way, we forwarded our list of kitchen equipment two weeks ago, but we haven't heard back.

To return the other person to a previous topic to maintain focus:

Anyway, about the appointment, how about Thursday the 12th?

To take attention off of yourself by claiming lack of knowledge:

I'm afraid I personally don't know about that document. Let me find out.

